GRILLED CORN ORZO SALAD

An incredibly flavorful salad with surprising ingredients –that will exceed all expectations. Every time I make this salad, I get asked for the recipe. And my son Max turned me onto this salad!

Origin

Pasta salad originated from Mediterranean traditions of serving cold pasta with oil and herbs, but modern, creamy, and mayonnaise-based versions popular today largely developed in the United States during the early-to-mid 20th century. While Italian pasta fredda (cold pasta) consists of fresh vegetables and olive oil, American macaroni salad became a staple due to industrial, prepared ingredients and post-WWII, convenience-focused dining

At a Glance

- **Prep Time:** Estimated time, 20-30 minutes
- **Cook Time:** Estimated time, 30 minutes
- **Servings:** Number of servings, 6-8

Preparation – *Mis en place* –*Everything in its place*

Tasks to complete before the main cooking begins to ensure a smooth process.

- **Soak/Activate:** boil water for orzo
- **Grill, griddle, pan fry:** corn, artichokes, scallions
- **Chop/Dice:** arugula, scallions, artichokes,
- **Assemble Tools:** griddle, cooking sheet, pot, large bowl for serving

Ingredients

Primary Plant Protein/Base:

- 12 oz edamame (can add more if you like ☺)

Fresh Produce & Aromatics:

- 3 ears of corn
- Arugula

Dressing

- 1 bunch green onions
- 1 lemon – juice and zest
- 5 cloves of garlic
- ¼ cup of fresh dill
- 1 tbs – fresh oregano
- 3- 4 cups arugula- roughly chopped
- ¼ - ½ tsp red pepper flakes
- 1 tsp miso paste
- ¼ cup olive oil
- 1-2 tsp of avocado oil
- 1 tbs white vinegar

Pantry Staples & Seasonings:

- 1 cup orzo
- 2 cans artichoke hearts – roughly chopped

Garnishes/Toppings: ○ n/a

🔪 Directions

Clear, sequential steps to guide the cooking process. Cook in "layers"

1. **Prepare**

    1. **Orzo** –boil water with a generous amount of salt and cook until al dente. Let cool – but do not put in the refrigerator. Orzo is best when it is slightly warm, not hot or cold

2. **Pre- cook artichokes, scallions, corn and edamame**

    1. Roughly chop **artichokes,** a little Olive oil spray with a little salt and pepper and put in 400 degrees. Remove from the oven as they get lightly crispy.
    2. Steam **corn** in microwave for 8 mins (wrap each corn in wet paper towel) and then put on griddle or grill. Keep turning to lightly char. Cut the corn kernels from the cob.
    3. Steam **edamame** until al dente – cook for 3 mins, try, and add more time if needed.

    Prepare the ingredients for the **dressing** –

    4. Grill the **scallions** – trim the roots of the scallions and separate the white and dark green parts. Set the greens aside. Add the white parts to the hot grill pan and sear for 1-2 mins per side. Pressing down gently with a spatula. Goal is to have char!! At the same time, add the **garlic cloves** and avocado oil to one side of the pan and sauté for 2-3 mins until fragrant and golden. Set scallions and garlic aside. Goal is char!!

3. **Make the dressing** – in a blender, add the sauteed garlic, 4 of the seared scallions, lemon zest and juice, vinegar, olive oil, miso and ½ tsp salt. Blend until smooth. Add the dill and blend again until fully incorporated. Taste and adjust salt or acidity as needed.

4. **Combine the rest of ingredients**

    1. Thinly slice the remaining cooked scallions and raw scallion greens.
    2. Add the corn, scallions, artichoke hearts, edamame, oregano, arugula and red pepper flakes to the bowl of orzo.
    3. When ready to serve, pour about half the **dressing** over top. Only add more if needed – extra dressing is perfect to use as a dip for other things including another salad
    4. Taste and adjust seasoning with more salt or lemon juice. Roughly chop **arugula**

Quick Tips

Bonus advice for variations, efficiency, and sustainability.

- **Flavor Boost:** add more edamame and or orzo if you want a less leafy salad.
- **Substitution:** can add avocado, charred asparagus, or even cherry tomatoes
- **Meal Prep Hack:** if you have a large portion and don't want to serve it all – don't add the dressing in its entirety. Separate the parts you don't want to serve and combine later along with adding the dressing when ready to serve

Nutritional Information

Estimated values Per ½ cup

Artichokes	60 calories, 4 g protein: 7 gm fiber: no fat and no cholesterol. Like other green vegetables, they are rich in vitamin C, which is an age fighting antioxidants, boosts immune function and helps to produce collagen.
Edamame (soybeans)	93 calories: 18 g protein: 8 g fiber: 8 g fat: 14 g carb. Edamame is a top source of plant protein. It is a complete protein, meaning it provides all essential amino acids. Good source for fiber. Has healthy fats including omega-3 fats healthy acids.
Scallions	Per one onion 5 calories: 4 g of fiber: .3 g protein and 0 g fat Green onions are a vegetable that are an excellent source of vitamin K, vitamin A, Vitamin C, and folate. They are a low-calorie and low-fat food, however, are they are not a good source of protein or fiber.
Arugula	5 Calories, 0.3 g protein: .4 g carbs: .2 g fiber: .1 g fat Is a nutrient-dense, low-calorie cruciferous green rich in vitamins K, A, and C, along with calcium, potassium, and folate. An excellent for weight management. It is high in antioxidants and phytochemicals (glucosinolates) that may reduce cancer risk, lower inflammation, and support heart and bone health.
Orzo	1/3 cup dry- 200 calories: 7 g protein: 1g fat; 2 g fiber: 42 g carb While it offers decent protein, refined white orzo is relatively low in fiber and vitamins compared to whole grains. As a high-carb food, it is an excellent source of quick energy, often used as a pasta base in Mediterranean dishes.
Corn	88 calories: 2.7 gm protein: 11 g. Sodium: 2.3 gm fiber 1gms fat, 21 gm carbs Corn is a nutrient-dense, starchy vegetable rich in fiber, antioxidants (lutein, zeaxanthin), and vitamins B and C. It supports eye health, digestion, and provides energy without causing high blood sugar spikes.

Is edamame good for you?

Yes, edamame is highly nutritious and good for you. These young soybeans are a complete, plant-based protein packed with fiber, iron, and essential nutrients like vitamin K and folate. They support heart health, aid in blood sugar regulation, and may help with weight management.

Are soy products good for you?

Yes, soy products are generally considered very good for you, offering a nutrient-dense, plant-based protein source that can lower cholesterol and reduce heart disease risk. Whole soy foods like tofu, edamame, and tempeh are packed with isoflavones and fiber, making them a healthy alternative to red meat.